

Chapter 32 — "Spot the Pual" Passage Exercise

Num 22–23 · Gen 25 · Isa 43

Each numbered verb belongs to one of the stems you have already studied (Qal, Niphal, Hiphil, Hophal, or Piel/Pual). For each one, fill in: Pual? (Yes/No), Conjugation, PGN, Root, and Stem/Function. The answer key begins on the page marked "Answer Key".

Passage A — Numbers 22:6, 12; 23:8, 20 (Balaam cycle)

22:6

כִּי יֵדַעְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מִבָּרֵךְ וְאֲשֶׁר תָּאֵר יֹאֵר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	תְּבָרֵךְ				
2	מִבָּרֵךְ				
3	יֹאֵר				

22:12

לֹא תֵלֶךְ עִמָּהֶם לֹא תָאֵר אֶת הָעָם כִּי בָרוּךְ הוּא

"You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	תָּאֵר				
5	בָּרוּךְ				

23:8

מִה אֶקְבֵּל לֹא קִבֵּה אֶל יוֹמָהּ אֲזַעֵם לֹא זָעַם יְהוָה

"How shall I curse what God has not cursed, and how shall I denounce what the LORD has not denounced?"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	קִבֵּה				
7	זָעַם				

23:20

הִנֵּה בָרַךְ לְקַחְתִּי וַיְבָרֵךְ וְלֹא אֲשִׁיבָנָה

"Behold, I have received a command to bless; he has blessed, and I cannot revoke it."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	בָּרַךְ				

Passage B — Genesis 25:8, 10 (Death and Burial of Abraham)

Gen 25:8

וַיָּגַע וַיָּמָת אַבְרָהָם בְּשִׁיבָה טוֹבָה זָקֵן וְשָׂבַע וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל עַמּוּ

"He expired, and Abraham died at a good old age, old and full of years, and was gathered to his people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	וַיָּמָת				
10	וַיֵּאָסֶף				

Gen 25:9–10

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אֹתוֹ יִצְחָק וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל בְּנָיו אֶל מְעֵרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה ... שָׁמָּה קָבַר אֲבִרְהָם וְשָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ

"Isaac and Ishmael his sons buried him in the cave of Machpelah ... there Abraham was buried, and Sarah his wife."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	וַיִּקְבְּרוּ				
12	קָבַר				

Passage C — Exodus 14:4; Isaiah 43:23; Exodus 40:17 (Pual of ■■■■ + Hophal distractor)

Exo 14:4

וְכַבְדְּתִי בַּפָּרְעָה וּבְכָל חֵילוֹ

"And I will get glory through Pharaoh and all his host."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
13	וְכַבְדְּתִי				

Isa 43:23

לֹא כִבְדֹתַנִּי בְּקִרְבָּנֶיךָ

"You have not honored me with your offerings."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	כִּבְדֹתַנִּי				

Exo 40:17

וְהֻקְּםָה הַמִּשְׁכָּן בְּיוֹם הַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן

"The tabernacle was set up on the first day of the first month."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
15	הֻקְּםָה				

Reflection Questions

- In Passage A, verbs 1 (Piel) and 2 (Pual) come from the same root קָרַב. The root has R2=ר, which rejects Dagesh Forte. How does the Pual compensate for the missing dagesh, and why does this make the Pual and Piel of קָרַב harder to distinguish than strong-root counterparts?
- Verb 3 (וָרָא, Hophal) and verb 14 (כִּבְדֹתַנִּי, Pual) both express passive meaning. What is the key visual feature that distinguishes a Hophal from a Pual? What does each stem tell you about the corresponding active stem?
- Verbs 11 (Qal Wayyiqtol 3mp) and 12 (Pual Perfect 3ms) in Passage B both come from root קָבַר. Verb 11 is Qal active (Isaac and Ishmael bury Abraham); verb 12 is Pual passive (Abraham was buried). What does the Pual vowel pattern (Qibbutz under R1 + Dagesh Forte in R2) tell you about who performs the action?

Answer Key

Passages with correct answers shown in the green row below each verb.

Passage A — Numbers 22:6, 12; 23:8, 20 (Balaam cycle)

22:6

כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מִבָּרֵךְ וְאֲשֶׁר תָּאֵר יִאָּר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	תְּבָרֵךְ				see ↓
✓	תְּבָרֵךְ	Imperfect	2ms	בָּרַךְ	NOT Pual — Piel Intensive: "you bless";
2	מִבָּרֵךְ				see ↓
✓	מִבָּרֵךְ	Participle	ms	בָּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Ptc. ms; Qamets under
3	יִאָּר				see ↓
✓	יִאָּר	Imperfect	3ms	אָרַר	NOT Pual — Hophal: "shall be cursed";

22:12

לֹא תֵלֶךְ עִמָּהֶם לֹא תָאֵר אֶת הָעָם כִּי בָרוּךְ הוּא

"You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	תָּאֵר				see ↓
✓	תָּאֵר	Imperfect	2ms	אָרַר	NOT Pual — Qal: "you shall curse"; no
5	בָּרוּךְ				see ↓
✓	בָּרוּךְ	Participle	ms	בָּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Ptc. ms (substantival:

23:8

מִה אֶקְבֵּל לֹא קִבֵּה אֶל יוֹמָהּ אֲזַעֵם לֹא זַעַם יְהוָה

"How shall I curse what God has not cursed, and how shall I denounce what the LORD has not denounced?"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	קִבֵּה				see ↓
✓	קִבֵּה	Qal Inf.Abs.	—	קָבַע	NOT Pual — Qal Inf. Abs.; geminate
7	זַעַם				see ↓
✓	זַעַם	Perfect	3ms	זָעַם	NOT Pual — Qal Perf. 3ms;

23:20

הִנֵּה בָרַךְ לְקַחְתִּי וַיְבָרֵךְ וְלֹא אֲשִׁיבָנָה

"Behold, I have received a command to bless; he has blessed, and I cannot revoke it."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	בָּרַךְ				see ↓
✓	בָּרַךְ	Inf. Absolute	—	בָּרַךְ	NOT Pual — Piel Inf. Abs.: "to bless";

Passage B — Genesis 25:8, 10 (Death and Burial of Abraham)

Gen 25:8

וַיָּגוּעַ וַיָּמָת אַבְרָהָם בְּשִׂיבָה טוֹבָה זָקֵן וְשָׂבַע וַיֵּאָסֶף אֶל עַמּוּיוֹ

"He expired, and Abraham died at a good old age, old and full of years, and was gathered to his people."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	וַיָּמָת				see ↓
✓	וַיָּמָת	Wayyiqtol	3ms	מוֹת	NOT Pual — Qal Wayyiqtol: "and
10	וַיֵּאָסֶף				see ↓
✓	וַיֵּאָסֶף	Wayyiqtol	3ms	אָסַף	NOT Pual — Niphal passive: "was

Gen 25:9–10

וַיִּקְבְּרוּ אוֹתוֹ יִצְחָק וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל בְּנוֹיו אֶל מְעַרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה ... שָׁמָּה קָבַר אַבְרָהָם וְשָׂרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ

"Isaac and Ishmael his sons buried him in the cave of Machpelah ... there Abraham was buried, and Sarah his wife."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
11	וַיִּקְבְּרוּ				see ↓
✓	וַיִּקְבְּרוּ	Wayyiqtol	3mp	קָבַר	NOT Pual — Qal active: "and they
12	קָבַר				see ↓
✓	קָבַר	Perfect	3ms	קָבַר	Passive — Pual: "was buried"; Qibbuts

Passage C — Exodus 14:4; Isaiah 43:23; Exodus 40:17 (Pual of ■■■■ + Hophal distractor)

Exo 14:4

וְכַבְדִּיתִי בְּפָרְעָה וּבְכָל חֵילוֹ

"And I will get glory through Pharaoh and all his host."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
13	וְכַבְדִּיתִי				see ↓
✓	וְכַבְדִּיתִי	Weqatal	1cs	כָּבַד	NOT Pual — Niphal reflexive: "I will be

Isa 43:23

לֹא כִבְדִתָּנִי בְּקִרְבָּנֶיךָ

"You have not honored me with your offerings."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	כָּבַדְתִּנִּי				see ↓
✓	כָּבַדְתִּנִּי	Perfect	2ms	כָּבַד	Passive — Pual: "you have not honored"

Exo 40:17

הוֹקֵם הַמִּשְׁכָּן בְּיוֹם הַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן

"The tabernacle was set up on the first day of the first month."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
15	הוֹקֵם				see ↓
✓	הוֹקֵם	Perfect	3ms	קָוַם	NOT Pual — Hophal: "was set"